

Ten years ago, they wrote songs about you.
Now you owe three months' rent.

FIRST-PERSON ROGUELITE HORDE SHOOTER · EXTRACTION · GAME-SHOW SATIRE

A washed-up wizard, smoking his last pipe in a rented attic, signs up for The Grand Descent, the realm's deadliest dungeon game show, to pay his dwarf landlord. He immediately offends the arena's goblin cleaning crew. They take it personally.

Design pillars

WHAT IT'S ABOUT

Horde power fantasy
Vampire Survivors' build-up meets Quake's pace: dozens of goblins, constant level-ups, and rooms you use to funnel and blast them.

Buzz: power that costs control
Pipe shrines make you stronger and sloppier. Spells wobble, the world warps, and at 100% you transcend, then crash. Getting stronger means losing control.

Extract or descend
After every floor: bank your gold and pay rent, or go deeper for more and risk losing it all.

It's television
A sarcastic host, sponsors, an audience that rewards risky, stylish play. The dungeon is a set and the hazards are props.

Core loop

10–20 MIN RUNS

Attic hub → Floor: 3 waves → Level-ups → Extract / Descend → Boss → Pay rent

The Arcane wizard

FIRST CLASS

LMB	**Arcane Missile:** precise bolts; hit streaks build up to 4 charges.
Q	**Arcane Vortex:** pulls the horde into a clump and holds it.
E	**Arcane Explosion:** point-blank blast that spends every charge.
Move	Dash, jump; Blink as an upgrade.

Build, gather, spend. Charges also feed Buzz: the better you play, the less control you have. Run-based upgrades mutate the kit (splitting missiles, implosions, overload).

World & cast

DARK, ABSURD



- **The hero:** your own customised has-been, renting the attic of a dwarf-run house.
- **Grumbleton:** the landlord. Rent milestones are the story's chapters.
- **Skully:** the floating, terminally unimpressed skull who hosts the show.
- **The Cleaning Crew:** goblin janitors with brooms and spray bottles, led by boss **Head Custodian Grubbins** (mop sweeps, wet-floor puddles, a whistle for the night shift).

Look & sound

- **"Borderlands meets Daggerfall":** blocky pixel-textured 3D dungeons, comic-ink characters.
- **3D world, 2D inhabitants** (like Ion Fury): billboard sprites, 64 px per metre textures.
- **Strict colour language:** warm torchlight, magenta Buzz & arcane, green goblins, gold loot.
- **Hand-drawn final art** (Procreate) and an **original score** (Cubase) that detunes and drifts as Buzz rises.

Levels

- **Handmade rooms, randomly assembled**, each with variant slots and seeds for replayable layouts.
- **Positioning pays:** balconies, chokepoints, pillars, pits. Knock goblins off ledges for ring-outs; blow up sponsored barrels.
- **No safe spots:** goblins climb, jump down and hop walls; ranged sprayers punish camping.
- **A boss every few floors** as the season's set pieces.

Beyond the slice

- **Classes** unlocked with gold: barbarian, paladin, rogue, each with its own kit.
- **Traits** (Project Zomboid-style): a washed-up past as a perk list.
- **Fire & Frost** specs for the wizard.
- **Crowd favour:** play to type, and the audience drops aid into the dungeon.
- **Fellow tenants** and a magic TV that airs the show.

STATUS Playable prototype

Arcane kit, waves and level-ups, Buzz with Transcendence and Crash, five-plus floors, extraction, jumping and vertical rooms, placeholder art throughout. Early playtests: "one more run" for 20-minute stretches.

Next: vertical slice

Menus, saving and settings · story intro · environment art · Grubbins boss fight with its own music · balance pass · outside playtests.

Production

Solo developer. AI-assisted prototyping to find the fun fast; the final game is rebuilt by hand in C#, with all art and music made in-house.